

The Tipping Point



Fitness Factor

54.8% failed in the age- and gender-related fitness tests.

Stress Index

30% are highly stressed and 48% have significant psychosomatic ailments.



Cardiac Risk

56% are at risk of heart ailments due to various lifestyle factors—obesity, stress, inactivity, etc.

Substance Abuse

30% have significant health risk due to dependency on alcohol, smoking or paan.



Cancer Risk

25% are at risk for cancer not only because of dependencies, but also family history, occupation etc.

Health Score

is 58% for one lakh employees. A score below 60% indicates poor health.

Source: The National Corporate Wellness Report by Apollo Lifetime Wellness Rx 2008-09

moted morning workouts, Bharti Airtel sponsored marathons while TCS took up a "serenity" initiative to improve employee well-being.

It's about time too. Statistics tell a dismal story: India's loss in terms of potentially productive years due to lifestyle diseases is one of the highest in the world, reports a 2009 AC Nielsen study. Drop in productivity due to heart ailments in the young workforce will cost the country \$237 billion between 2005 and 2015, says the World Health Organization. India Inc tops the global stress league table and works the longest hours, shows up a Grant Thornton Report conducted in 32 countries last year. Not just. About 30 per cent of corporate employees are afflicted with obesity, diabetes, coronary ailments and back problems. Working women are sitting ducks for lifestyle disorders and 77 per cent remain undiagnosed due to lack of time (Assocham, 2009). Unproductive work atmosphere and uncooperative colleagues make 93 per cent of techies in Bangalore seriously depressed, shows a 2009 PeopleHealth study on 2,106 IT employees. "Sixty per cent of corporate executives between age 30-35 coming in for a check-up do not show symptoms, but for 80 per cent tests indicate risk factors for serious lifestyle disorders," says Dr Adrian Kennedy, head of Lifetime Wellness Rx International, an Apollo Hospitals group company.

The idea of wellness started as a trickle when celebrated US cardiac surgeons like Dean Ornish, Christian Barnard and Denton Cooley quantified the benefits of lifestyle modification in the 1970s. Jim Fixx, running guru and author of *The Complete Book of Running*, kicked off a jogging boom while Dr Kenneth Cooper and Jane Fonda made aerobics fashionable. In the '80s, diets—Atkins, GM—ruled the roost, while the '90s mined the mind-body connection. Think Dr Deepak Chopra. All these came to a head in the new millennium. A flurry of World Health Organization declarations—Bangkok Charter, Health for all Charter and the Luxembourg Charter on Corporate Wellness—made wellness essential for the

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community. "It's an age when no one wants to grow old, obese, sick, stressed or bored," says Bangalore-based cardiac surgeon Dr Devi Shetty. "The inner springs of the wellness industry globally lies in this attitude." Statistics tell the story of changing attitudes: 84 per cent Indians admit looking good is a higher priority today than in the previous generation; 76 per cent of women and 24 per cent of men visit spas to relax, detox, beautify and pamper themselves (AC Nielsen, 2007-09).

The hedonistic treadmill of looking good and feeling great is spawning a market sizzling with potential. "Even a decade back, healthcare was primarily diagnostic and therapeutic. Today if you don't cater to wellness, you'll find it hard to stay in business," says Gaurav Marya, President, Franchise India Holdings Ltd, which has brought out a healthcare, beauty and wellness report this year. A 2010 FICCI-Ernst & Young survey (Wellness: Exploring the Untapped Potential) reports that the sector covers seven core segments and 26 subcategories—counselling, beauty, fitness, nutrition, rejuvenation,